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Evolutionary Impacts of UAVs on Modern Systems

DOI: 10.1201/9788743812418-8

8.1 Introduction

The evolution of *Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs)*, commonly known as drones, represents one of the most transformative technological advancements of the 21st century. From their origins as experimental military tools to their current role in commercial, industrial, and humanitarian applications, UAVs have profoundly influenced modern systems across multiple domains. Their evolution embodies the convergence of *aerodynamics*, *artificial intelligence*, *robotics*, *and data science*, redefining how humans interact with the sky, gather information, and execute complex operations with unprecedented precision and efficiency.

The *evolutionary impact of UAVs* extends far beyond aviation; it touches nearly every sector of modern life. In *defense and security*, drones have revolutionized surveillance, reconnaissance, and precision targeting, while in *civil and industrial applications*, they have become indispensable for infrastructure inspection, agriculture, environmental monitoring, logistics, and disaster management. The ability of UAVs to access remote or hazardous environments has dramatically enhanced operational safety,